

it does not provide a major improvement in performance over the Nothing Phone 3a in daily use.

SOFTWARE & AI FEATURES

The device runs on bloatware-free Android 15-based Nothing OS 3.1 that offers a Nothing dot matrix engine, unique animations, and AI-driven optimisations. One of the key additions is the Essential Space, an AI-powered hub that helps organise notes, ideas, and more by acting as a centralised memory, helping in recalling the content when needed.

Nothing has introduced a dedicated Essential Key on the side of the phone for quick access: press it once to send content to Essential Space, long-press to record a voice note, and double-tap to view saved content.

While Essential Space will get out of beta with Nothing Phone 3, Phone 3a users get Early Access to test Camera Capture, Smart Collections, and Focused Search. But will it be able to integrate into our daily lives? Only time will tell.

BATTERY

The Nothing Phone 3a Pro comes backed with a 5,000 mAh battery with support for 50W fast charging. The company promises a full charge in under 56 minutes. During our charging test with a 25W adapter (to simulate more common charging scenarios), the phone took around 1 hour and 15 minutes to fully charge from 0 percent. The battery life is impressive, and it easily lasts over a full day with regular usage. In mixed usage which includes watching videos on YouTube, photo editing, document editing, browsing and checking Instagram feed, the Nothing 3a Pro gave a run time of 11 hours 17 minutes which is very good for a phone in this price range.

CAMERA

The Nothing Phone 3a Pro packs a



50MP primary camera (f/1.88, 1/1.56") with OIS, EIS, and dual-pixel PDAF, offering 2x in-sensor zoom for crisp shots. It's paired with a 50MP Sony periscope lens (f/2.55, 1/1.95") featuring 3x optical zoom, 6x digital crop, and 60x ultra zoom for detailed long-range photography. Completing the setup is an 8MP Sony ultra-wide camera (f/2.2) with a 120° FOV.

If you love shooting portraits, Nothing Phone 3a Pro's periscope telephoto camera will not disappoint. It can deliver crisp and detailed images with vibrant colours, but at times, the optimisation issues creep in. In some shots, the bokeh looked artificial, impacting the overall clarity of the image.

The 24mm, 50mm, 70mm, and 100mm portrait modes can help you take some good images with lively details. Beyond portraits, the phone captures true-to-life colours in daylight while avoiding oversaturation. I tested the camera under various lighting conditions, during my trip to Uttarakhand. On cloudy days, the images leaned toward cooler tones and had a pleasant warm hue in direct sunlight.

Night photography is another highlight of this camera setup. It retains excellent details and natural colours,

producing impressive low-light shots with minimal noise or artificial smoothing.

VERDICT

The Nothing Phone 3a Pro offers a good-looking, unique design language, a bright display, and a capable triple camera setup, making it yet another interesting mid-range option for buyers. However, there is a catch. The Snapdragon 7s Gen 3 chipset offers minimal improvement over the Nothing Phone 3a, raising questions about the "Pro" branding, especially when you get phones such as Poco F6 and the upcoming iQOO Neo 10R with Snapdragon 8s

Gen 3 SoC. Of course, the positioning of those devices is towards buyers who are looking for raw performance gains, and Nothing, with the Phone 3a Pro, wants to cater to users who prioritize design, a clean software experience, and a well-rounded camera system over sheer processing power.

The transparent aesthetic, Glyph interface, and Nothing OS's minimal, bloat-free approach set it apart in a crowded mid-range space. That said, with competitors offering flagship-grade chipsets at similar price points, the Phone 3a Pro's appeal hinges on whether buyers value Nothing's unique ecosystem and user experience over raw performance.

—Ashish Singh

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Snapdragon 7s Gen 3 | GPU: Adreno 710 (940 MHz) | RAM: 12GB | Storage: 256GB | OS: Android 15, Nothing OS 3.1 | Display: 6.77" AMOLED, 120Hz refresh rate, 2392x1080 pixels, 3000 nits peak brightness HDR10+ | IP Rating: IP64 | Cameras: 50 MP (main) + 50 MP (periscope telephoto) + 8 MP (ultrawide) | Selfie Camera: 50MP | Battery Capacity: 5,000 mAh | Charging: 50 W (wired)

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